
Autumn Peak-Season Food Calendar Jeoneo Daeha Kkotge

****Subtitle****

The real reason Koreans wait all year for autumn
from the salty sea (jeoneo

Why "Just One Autumn Season" — Why You Need to Know Before You Land

In Korean food culture, autumn is **the single most peak-season-dense stretch of the year**. Every one of the six items below disappears once its September–November window closes, and it's gone until next year (frozen and farmed substitutes aside). If your trip falls in autumn, **which week you land on** decides your menu — use this calendar to plan ahead.

Season	Sep	Oct	Nov
Jeoneo (전어, gizzard shad)	☉ Peak begins	☉ Peak	△ Tail end
Daeha (대하, king prawn)	☉ Begins	☉ Peak	△
Kkotge (꽃게, blue crab)	○	☉ Peak	☉
Songgi (송이버섯, matsutake mushroom)	☉ Short peak	○ Through early Oct	
Hongsi · Dan-gam (홍시·단감, ripe & firm persimmon)		○ Begins	☉ Peak
Hatbam · Gunbam (햇밤·군밤, roasted chestnut)	○	☉	☉ (continues into winter)

① The 6-Item Peak-Season Overview

1. Jeoneo — "Even the Runaway Daughter-in-Law Comes Back"

- The fish behind Korea's best-known autumn-food saying: "**Jip nagan myeoneuri-do dora-onda**" (집 나간 며느리도 돌아온다) — literally "even the daughter-in-law who left home comes back." It means the smell of grilling jeoneo is good enough to lure back someone who's already walked out the door. By September–October the fish fattens up, and both hoe (raw) and grilled versions hit their peak.
- **How to eat it:** sekkoshi (세꼬시, bone-in sliced raw fish — a term borrowed from Japanese sebagoshi/segoshi, the small bones left in for crunch) or whole-grilled with coarse salt. About ₩15,000–25,000 (~\$11–18 / ~80–140 RMB / ~1,600–2,700 JPY) per person.
- **Where:** fish markets like Noryangjin (노량진) and Soraepogu (소래포구) — see the Seafood Market Channel Comparison guide for how the two compare — or as a seasonal drinking-snack order in autumn yajang (야장, open-air pop-up seating that spills onto the sidewalk) alleys.

2. Daeha — Salt-Grilling Season

- Peak season along the West Sea coast in September–October. The classic method: **daeha sogeum-gui** (소금구이, whole prawns grilled over a bed of coarse salt in the pan) — watching the prawns curl and flush red is a signature scene of Korean autumn.

- **Wild vs. farmed:** wild daeha are wired to die almost the moment they're caught, so nearly all wild daeha reach the table already dead — a tank of "live daeha" is almost always the farmed whiteleg shrimp (흰다리새우) instead. Don't let that fool you; the taste difference is minor.
- About ₩30,000–50,000 per kg (prices swing hard with the catch). The Soraepogu area typically runs a shrimp-and-daeha season event around September–October most years — check dates on-site, since they vary year to year.

3. Kkotge — Autumn Belongs to the Males

- Spring kkotge means roe-packed females; **autumn kkotge means meat-packed males** — same crab, different season, different part of the animal to chase.
- **How to eat it:** steamed or in a spicy stew, and the rice-thief classic, ganjang-gejang (간장게장, raw crab marinated in soy sauce). A ganjang-gejang jeongsik (정식, full set meal with rice and banchan) runs ₩25,000–45,000.
- For seafood basics, see the Seafood 6-Type Overview guide; for how to buy straight from the market and eat it at a chojang-jip (초장집, a restaurant that plates your market seafood with chili-vinegar dip for a seating fee), see the Seafood Market Channel Comparison guide.

4. Songi — The Shortest, Priciest Window of the Year

- Mid-September to early October — **a window of barely three weeks**. Because songi can't be farmed and only grows wild, it's the priciest item on Korea's autumn table (tens of thousands of won per 100g, depending on the season's yield).
- **How travelers get access:** order the "songi course" at a hanjeongsik (한정식, a multi-course Korean set-table meal) restaurant or barbecue house, or try songi-bulgogi (mushroom grilled with beef) — you don't have to travel to growing regions like Yangyang (양양) or Bonghwa (봉화); Seoul hanjeongsik restaurants run it as an autumn-only special.
- The aroma is the whole point — the classic way to eat it is barely grilled, dipped lightly in salt.

5. Hongsi & Dan-gam — Late Autumn's Dessert

- Late October into November, persimmons ripen. The soft, jammy hongsi (홍시, overripe persimmon eaten with a spoon like a natural pudding) and the crisp, firm dan-gam (단감, sweet persimmon peeled and eaten like an apple) are two different fruits from the same tree.
- For the café version — hongsi bingsu (shaved ice) and other persimmon desserts — see the Korea Autumn Dessert Map.

6. Hatbam & Gunbam — The Smell of Autumn on the Street

- From October, street-corner gunbam (군밤, roasted chestnut) carts appear — the start of a street-snack season that runs through winter. About ₩5,000 a bag.
- Regional specialties like Gongju albam (공주 알밤, Gongju's prized chestnuts) pair well with day trips out of Seoul — see the Gapyeong·Yangpyeong Autumn Foliage Day-Trip guide or the Gangwon·Jeolla Autumn KTX Day-Trip guide.

② Where to Eat — 3 Traveler Route Patterns

Pattern	Route	Best for
Market direct	Buy jeoneo, daeha, and kkotge at Noryangjin or Soraepogu, then eat it at a chojang-jip (plus a seating fee)	Food-focused travelers (see the Seafood Market Channel Comparison guide)
Yajang seasonal snacks	Grilled jeoneo and daeha as a seasonal special at Euljiro (을지로) or Sindang (신당) yajang	Pairs with an evening course (see the Myeongdong→Euljiro Evening Walking Course guide and the Sindang-dong guide)
Hanjeongsik course	Songi, gejang, and hongsi on one table — reservation-based	Comfort-first, families

On-the-Ground List — Where to Eat Autumn Raw Shrimp & Daeha (8 Named Local-Curation Spots)

Pulled from Instagram local-foodie curation (as of 2026-08, cross-sourced) — autumn shrimp/daeha spots that keep showing up across multiple curators, weighted toward neighborhoods that are easy for travelers to reach. **Confirm hours and pricing on-site** (seasonal shops change often).

Name	Neighborhood	Why it's here
Haeundae Hoe-sekkosi (해운대회세꼬시)	Jongno, Donui-dong (종로 돈의동)	Cross-appears in multiple curations — a raw-shrimp/sekkosi pocha alley
Haeundae Pocha (해운대포차)	Jongno, Myo-dong (종로 묘동)	Walking distance from Ikseon-dong — pairs with an evening course
Ulleungjip (울릉집)	Yongsan, Samgakji (용산 삼각지)	In the Yongridan-gil strip — old-school feel
Yongsan Odeng (용산오뎅)	Yongsan, Hangang-ro (용산 한강로)	A pocha pairing odeng with raw shrimp
Yeonnam Jamsuham (연남잠수함)	Yeonnam-dong (연남동)	Easy add-on to a Hongdae/Yeonnam itinerary
Yeonnam Eobu (연남어부)	Yeonnam-dong (연남동)	Built around salt-grilled daeha
Sicily (시실리)	Mapo, Gongdeok (마포 공덕)	Shrimp specialist — in the Gongdeok after-work dining alley
Nowon Daeha-gui (노원대하구이)	Nowon (노원)	The name is the menu — grilled-daeha specialist

Pre-Trip Checklist

- [] **Match your travel week to the season** — check which items hit ☉ on your dates in the calendar above (e.g., mid-September = a triple window of jeoneo + daeha + songi)
- [] **Study the market routine in advance** — understanding how a fish-market chojang-jip works (buy first, pay a seating fee) via the Seafood Market Channel Comparison guide makes on-site bargaining much easier
- [] **Book gejang and hanjeongsik ahead** — well-known gejang restaurants have long dinner waits. Reserve via Catch Table (캐치테이블, Korea's most-used restaurant reservation app) or by phone
- [] **Expect market pricing, not fixed pricing** — wild songi and daeha swing hard with the season's yield, so go in knowing it's a market rate, not a menu price
- [] **Prep the allergy phrase** — if you have a shellfish allergy, have "gapgakryu allergy isseoyo" (갑각류 알레르기 있어요, "I have a shellfish allergy") ready

Keep Reading

- **Korea Autumn Dessert Map** (the sweet side of persimmon, chestnut, pumpkin) · **Korean Seasonal Raw Fish Monthly Guide**
- **Seafood Market Channel Comparison** (Noryangjin vs. Soraepogu vs. Jagalchi) · **Seafood 6-Type Overview**
- **Myeongdong→Euljiro Evening Walking Course** · **Sindang-dong guide** — the night stage for autumn drinking snacks

Verification Notes (Check Before Publishing)

- **Fact anchors:** the jeoneo proverb and its September–October season; wild daeha typically reaching market already dead (with "live daeha" tanks understood as farmed stock); autumn kkotge = males vs. spring = females; wild songi's narrow mid-September–early-October window; persimmons ripening from late October — all standard, widely accepted seafood and produce knowledge. Prices and event dates are variable, so they're flagged as "typical years / confirm on-site" rather than asserting a specific year's festival schedule.
- **Creative boundaries:** all prices given as ranges. The 8 named venues are drawn from cross-sourced IG local curation (seed report §2-A, updated 2026-08-20) — flagged with an on-site hours/pricing verification caveat.
- **Coverage check:** zero existing savory autumn-season content as of the 2026-08-20 contents.json cross-check — no prior tags or titles for jeoneo, daeha, or songi; kkotge appears only as a species mention in the Seafood 6-Type Overview guide.

Tags

#가을제철 #KoreaAutumnFood #전어 #Jeoneo #대하 #DaehaShrimp #꽃게 #간장게장 #송이버섯
#SongiMushroom #제철캘린더 #키친구